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NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GOA

Cuncolim, Salcete, South Goa-403703

Programme Name: B.Tech.

Mid Semester Examinations, October-2025

Section: C

Course Name: Professional Communication

Date: 11/10/2025

Course Code: HU150-

Time: 02:00 pm- 03:30 pm

Duration: 1.5 Hours

Max. Marks: 50

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS

Read the Cases and Answer the Following Questions
Case Study 1:

6*4=24

A university is conducting a **virtual orientation program** for new students. The event is hosted on an online platform.

- The Dean's presentation is interrupted by constant construction noise near his office and a few students logging in late miss important parts.
 - Some students feel anxious and distracted as they are new, while others get bored due to the Dean's monotone delivery.
 - The slides contain difficult terms, and one section is overloaded with unnecessary data.
 - A group of students create a WhatsApp group where informal communication spreads exaggerated rumors about attendance rules and exams.
 - During the Q&A session, some students give feedback by asking for clarification, while others simply write "okay" without fully understanding.
 - A survey later shows that students used different listening styles: some were attentive, while others admitted they were just listeners with cameras off.
1. How did both noise and psychological factors combine to affect the effectiveness of the Dean's presentation?
 2. Critically evaluate how barriers reduced the clarity of the orientation session by explaining various forms of barriers?
 3. Compare the feedback given by students and explain how each shaped the outcome of communication.
 4. Analyze the impact of grapevine communication through WhatsApp on students' perceptions of university policies.
 5. Discuss how different types of listening influenced the learning outcomes of the orientation.
 6. As an organizer, what multi-step strategy would you recommend to overcome these barriers and make future online sessions more effective?

Case Study 2:**5*4=20**

In a corporate interview panel, five candidates were being assessed not only on their answers but also on their **nonverbal cues**:

- Candidate A entered the room with a creaped posture, avoided eye contact, and fidgeted with his pen while answering.
 - Candidate B arrived late, apologized, but spoke with confidence; however, his monotone paralanguage made the panel doubtful of his enthusiasm.
 - Candidate C dressed very formally, maintained steady eye contact, and used appropriate gestures, but his nervous smile gave away his anxiety.
 - Candidate D, though knowledgeable, kept silent for long pauses, which the panel interpreted as hesitation.
 - Candidate E wore flashy accessories and overpowering perfume, which distracted the panel more than his actual responses.
7. How did the kinesics (posture, gestures, facial expressions) of Candidate A and C influence the panel's perception?
8. Candidate B's case highlights the role of paralanguage in communication. Critically analyze how it impacted his interview outcome.
9. What role did chronemics and silence play in shaping the impression of Candidate B and Candidate D?
10. Discuss how artifacts and olfactics affected the panel's judgment of Candidate E.
11. From this scenario, evaluate why nonverbal communication often "speaks louder than words" in professional settings.

12. Match the following**(6*1=06)**

Column A	Column B
A. Diagonal Communication	Sharing of reports among colleagues at the same level
B. Extrapersonal Communication	Sales manager directly interacting with VP (Production) of another branch
C. Upward Communication	A pet dog wagging its tail on seeing its owner
D. Intrapersonal Communication	A press conference by the chairman of a company
E. Horizontal Communication	Internal dialogue that guides self-motivation
F. Mass Communication	Reports/statistical data sent for decision making

All the Best !



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GOA

Cuncolim, Salcete, South Goa-403703

Programme Name: B.Tech.

Mid Semester Examinations, March-2026

Section: B

Roll No	2	5	E	C	E	1	0	3	7
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Course Name: Professional Communication

Date: 03/03/2026

Duration: 1.5 Hours

Course Code: HU150

Time: 10:00 am- 11:30 am

Max. Marks: 50

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS

(Number your answers correctly)

I. ANSWER TRUE OR FALSE FOR THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS (1x6=6 marks)

1. Companies that follow an upward communication network do not hold exit interviews for employees resigning from their posts.
2. A company's external communication must necessarily adopt a formal mode of interaction.
3. In the context of professional communication, building credibility is a spontaneous outcome.
4. A movie theatre luring its audience with the smell of popcorn uses the olfactory principle of non-verbal communication to advertise its food.
5. According to Edward Hall's proxemic classification of nonverbal communication, large public gatherings must position their participants within the social zone.
6. A grapevine communication channel can help in faster sharing of information within a company.

II. ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS (2x4 =8 marks)

7. In the context of providing feedback, how can consumers and businesses utilise 'social listening' to enable effective communication?
8. How is hearing different from listening? Give **one example each**.
9. A mental health practitioner neither seeks the patients' medical history nor lets them talk about their problems. She barely looks at them and is quick to prescribe a heavy

dose of medication. What kind of a listener is the practitioner? Which kind of listening should she have adopted in this case?

10. Peter is attentive in class but is unable to respond to questions that the professor asks. What stage of the listening process is Peter failing to achieve? Name one effective strategy that he can adopt to overcome this difficulty and be an efficient listener.

III. ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS

(4x4=16 marks)

11. How differently should 'I- messages' and 'You-messages' be used in the following two scenarios? Give **two** reasons each to support your answer
- While holding an interactive discussion *2 reasons focus on both First*
 - While offering corrective feedback *2 reasons (give reasons)*
12. What is noise in communication? What are the **two** kinds of noises that one may encounter in a communication loop? Give **one** example each. *give specific examples*
13. Match the **four** options in List A with their appropriate **four** options (out of the 5 provided) in List B. Write the alphabet that correspond the options you wish to match (Ex, A—H).

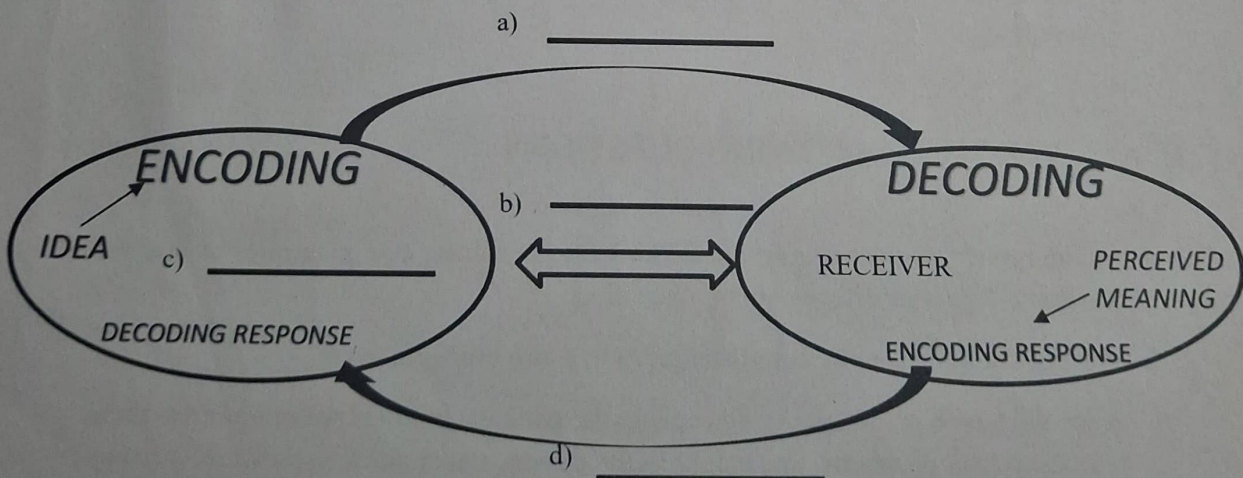
Column A

- Effective listening
- Correctness
- Gossip chain
- Turn-taking

Column B

- Using words that are anti-discriminatory
- Intentional selection of participants ✗
- Withholds judgmental attitude ✗
- News spreads randomly ✗
- Sender prompts responses ✗ through cues

14. Fill in the missing elements of the flow diagram depicting the communication process.



IV. ANALYSE THE CASES AND ANSWER THE QUESTIONS THAT FOLLOW (10x2=20 marks)

15. During a weekly project review meeting, the team manager, Koel, addresses the delay in client deliverables in a recent project they undertook for the AppTech company. As there were a few coordination issues between the design and operations teams, Koel felt that the teams could have planned and coordinated their work in advance to avoid the delay. Nevertheless, the client was pleased with the project and appreciated the team's work. At the review meeting, the manager gives the following feedback: (10 Marks)

"You guys are clearly not taking deadlines seriously. You have always been disorganised and have repeatedly postponed the work till the very end. This kind of performance is unacceptable, and this needs to be fixed immediately."

She ended the meeting with these words, and the team members walked out of the room feeling dejected.

- a) Why is feedback significant in communication? Give **any two** reasons. (2 marks)
- b) What are **the two** kinds of feedback in professional communication? What kind of feedback was Koel giving? (2 Marks)
- c) What was wrong with Koel's feedback? Cite **three** reasons describing why it failed. (3 marks)
- d) Imagine you are Koel. Drawing from your knowledge of framing feedback and using the information available above, rewrite the message effectively by rectifying the **three** drawbacks you identified earlier. (3 marks)

16. As part of the course *Mental Health and Wellbeing*, a professor sends the following email to his students regarding an end-of-semester assignment: (10 Marks)

Dear students,

As a fitting culmination to our semester-long, intellectually stimulating and conceptually layered journey of mental well-being and self-discovery, you are hereby required to make a thoughtfully composed, written submission that adequately captures the mental evolution effected by the collective academic discourse. This assignment, which should be of an appropriate length and demonstrative of rigorous scholarly effort, is to be uploaded online by EoD. I expect you to adhere to the deadline.

- a) Identify **three** of the 7Cs of professional communication that the above email violates. (3 marks)
- b) Pick out **four** incorrect words or groups of words from the email that violate the 7Cs of communication. Explain each selection briefly. (4 marks)
- c) Imagine you are the professor in the above communication scenario. Rewrite the above email by replacing any incorrect words or groups of words and incorporating all the necessary details to rectify the previously identified **three** errors in the 7Cs of communication. You may supply details wherever required, provided they are consistent with the context. (**Do not write more than six sentences**) (3 marks)



NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY GOA

Cuncolim, Salcete, South Goa-403703

Programme Name: B.Tech. (Section B)

End Semester Examinations, Apr-May 2026

Course Name: Professional Communication

Date: 30-04-2026

Duration: 3 Hours

Course Code: HU150

Time: 10.00 am -1.00 pm

Max. Marks: 100

ANSWER ALL QUESTIONS

Section I

State true or false (10x1=10 marks)

1. Hearing is an involuntary process, while listening is a voluntary process.
2. Mental turbulence and anxiety are two kinds of physical noise in a communication loop.
3. In a successful communication scenario, the sender and the receiver cannot have differences in opinions.
4. In the context of communication barriers, a message is said to be lost in transmission when the receiver holds a prejudiced view against the sender.
5. When writing reference initials in a business letter, the initials of the one who drafted the letter follow the initials of the one who signed it.
6. Most chocolate manufacturers use bright-coloured wrappers, in keeping with the chromatic principle of non-verbal communication.
7. In the context of writing business letters, the BCC option lets you hide the details of the other recipients of a letter, while the CC option does not.
8. Companies always adopt a formal mode of communication when interacting with external entities and stakeholders.
9. A complimentary close is added to the opening segment of a business letter.
10. While giving corrective feedback, using 'You-messages' instead of 'I-messages' ensures favourable outcomes.

Section II

Answer the following questions [(5x2=10 marks) + (1x7=7 marks) = 17 marks]

11. Explain the role of empathy in professional communication using an example. (2 marks)
12. What is paralinguistics? How is it relevant to achieving effective communication? (2 marks)
13. In the context of feedback, how do businesses benefit from social listening? (2 marks)
14. What is psychological noise? Give one example. (2 marks)
15. What flow of communication does a company maintaining an open-door policy support? What could be one disadvantage of such a communication flow? (2 marks)
16. What are the 7Cs of effective communication? Explain your answer (7 marks)

Section III

17. MedLife, a fitness company, is launching a new AI-powered health band, 'FitBand X', in June 2026. During its global multi-channel launch event, the company connects with its target customers through live-streaming on its website, with news media outlets through press releases and with select social media influencers through virtual meet-ups to promote the product. The CEO, Paul D'mello, announces;

"FitBand X integrates adaptive AI-health tracker technology with user medical history to offer personalised well-being insights in real time"

Some consumers interpreted 'personalised well-being insights' as medical diagnoses. News media outlets were wary of advertising the product due to concerns about a potential breach of sensitive medical information. Social media influencers were unsure of the legal implications of marketing a product which could, they feared, be misinterpreted as a medical device rather than a lifestyle product. (6+2+2=10 marks)

- MedLife is the sender for three separate communication loops in the above scenario. Identify the receiver and channel in all three loops separately. You may name the communication loops 1, 2 and 3, respectively, in your answer (6 marks)
 - Identify two sender-oriented communication barriers that caused the failure in the communication loop. Explain (2 marks)
 - How could MedLife have prevented these communication barriers? (2 marks)
18. TechSolutions is proposing to launch a new Daily Planner App in the market, aiming to help employees plan, schedule and execute their tasks for effective functioning. The company's research team decides to introduce the Daily Planner App initially to a small group within their project management team for pilot testing. During lunch, one of the members of the test group mentioned the app to his other colleagues from other departments. He notes how the app's advanced interface has already helped them reduce distractions and be more productive. The news about the app spreads quickly throughout the company during casual chit chats, group messaging platforms and hallway discussions. Employees from across the company's departments began installing and using the app even before the company introduced it officially. Soon, TechSolutions was able to use the feedback generated by its own employees for refining the app before launching it into the market.

(1+3+4+2 = 10 marks)

- Name the form of internal communication channel that was adopted in the above case scenario? (1 mark)
 - How is it different from the other forms of internal communication channels in a company? State three differences. (3 marks)
 - What are the four chains into which it is further subdivided? (4 marks)
 - Although the network worked favourably in the above case, discuss any two potential disadvantages that such a communication network could have caused. (2 marks)
19. Study the following corrective feedback offered by a team leader to a member. Identify any three problems with it. Cite phrases from the text to explain your points. (3 marks)

Your report is extremely disappointing. It's clear that you didn't understand the project at all. This is not the level of performance I expected from you. I do not have the time to fix your mistakes. You need to figure it out.

Section IV

20. You are the manager of WeWork, a co-working space in Panjim, which enables small businesses and start-ups to use its fully-equipped, ready-to-use workspaces as their primary office to work from, under a monthly subscription plan. A new start-up law firm, Rodrigues & Co, has written to you asking to let them use your space for three days a week (Mondays, Tuesdays and Thursdays) under a one-year contract. As your company policy does not allow long-term contracts, write a response letter to the Managing Director, politely denying their request by citing appropriate reasons. Also, propose alternative arrangements that may let them use WeWork within your company guidelines. Invent all the required details and reasons to effectively communicate your refusal and possible solutions, while maintaining a professional tone. **(10 marks)**

21. You are Mr. Madan Dutta, the Marketing Director of Make Your Trip Holidays Ltd. Your company is offering attractive summer holiday packages for international trips from India as part of the Great Indian Summer Travel sale from May 2026 to July 2026. You hear that We-Tech Software Solutions is looking for a tour operator for an employee's trip to Europe. Write a persuasive sales letter to Ms. Seema Banu, the Managing Director of We-Tech Software Solutions, convincing her why your company is the best tour operator for them. Include details about your attractive packages, your all-inclusive (travel, accommodation, sightseeing and food) itinerary plans and hassle-free assistance for visa processing. Do not forget to include the discounts and other customised services that you offer. Imagine all the necessary details to write this effective sales letter. **(10 marks)**

22. Your company has recently resumed full-time, office-based operations after five years of remote and hybrid work. As the CEO, you have observed a significant rise in client complaints regarding the declining quality of work since this transition. You recognise that employees are finding it difficult to change from flexible schedules, extended deadlines, and virtual collaboration to structured work hours and in-person interactions. You believe that excessive screen dependency, poor time management, and a lack of workplace discipline are major factors contributing to reduced productivity.

Write a detailed memo addressing employees in which you:

- Acknowledge the decline in performance and the challenges associated with the transition.
 - Identify and explain the key factors affecting productivity.
 - Emphasise the importance of improving interpersonal communication and collaboration.
 - Suggest practical measures and team-based activities to enhance time management, rebuild trust among employees, and encourage mindful use of screens
- (10 marks)**

23. Your institute is proposing to organise a city Marathon as a fundraising event to provide financial support for the building of a primary school in your area. As the Student President of your institution, you plan to conduct a meeting of volunteers who wish to be a part of the cause. Write an agenda for the meeting, listing clear and specific discussion points related to the planning, execution and publicising of the Marathon. **(10 marks)**

24. Your institute is hosting an inter-collegiate tech fest, Technovanza 2026, on the 5th and 6th of May. You are the Chief Coordinator of the fest. You held a meeting of the heads of the various committees on the 20th of April 2026 to finalise the budget, program schedule, guest list and several other aspects of the fest. Draft the minutes of the meeting to be sent to the attendees, listing each of the agenda topics, the discussions that followed and the decisions taken. You may imagine all relevant details. **(10 marks)**